Oven



Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 8 labs

Covers these lab items: Baking oven; Commercial Oven (Deck/Convection); Convection Oven; Deck Oven; Oven; Rotary Oven; Tandoor/OTG

What it is used for

An oven uses controlled heat to bake, roast, or cook suitable food and materials. Correct temperature settings, safe loading, and regular cleaning help prevent burns, fire, and uneven cooking.

Main parts

- Cooking chamber contains the food during heating.
- Heating elements or burners produce heat.
- Temperature control sets the required cooking temperature.
- Thermostat or sensor monitors the chamber temperature.
- Door and insulated handle help contain heat and provide access.
- Racks, trays, or shelves support the items being heated.
- Timer and control panel manage cooking duration and operating settings.

Before you start

1. Read the manufacturer's instructions and confirm the oven suits the intended cooking task.
2. Inspect the door, handle, racks, controls, power cord, or gas connections for damage.
3. Place the oven on a stable surface with adequate ventilation and clearance.
4. Keep the chamber clean and remove grease, loose food, and unnecessary objects.
5. Use suitable heat-resistant gloves and check that trays and utensils are oven-safe.
6. Preheat the oven to the temperature specified in the recipe or operating instructions.

How to use

1. Switch on the oven using the approved controls and select the required heating mode.
2. Set the required temperature and preheating time according to the recipe or instructions.
3. Prepare food in suitable trays and arrange items with enough space for heat circulation.
4. Open the door carefully, keeping your face and hands away from escaping hot air.
5. Place trays on the appropriate rack and close the door securely.
6. Set the cooking timer and monitor the process through the window when available.
7. Use heat-resistant gloves when checking, turning, or removing hot trays.
8. Check that the food is cooked adequately using the appropriate food-safety method.
9. Switch off the oven after use and remove food carefully.
10. Allow the oven to cool before cleaning the chamber, racks, and accessible surfaces.

⚠ Safety

- Never touch heating elements, hot trays, or internal surfaces with bare hands.
- Keep children and unauthorised users away from the hot oven.
- Never block ventilation openings or leave flammable materials near the oven.
- Do not use an oven with damaged wiring, gas connections, door seals, or controls.
- For gas ovens, shut off the supply if you smell gas and follow emergency procedures.
- Do not pour cold water onto hot glass or heating components.

Care & storage

- Switch off and disconnect electrical power before cleaning, where safe and applicable.
- Remove food residue and grease using manufacturer-approved cleaning methods.
- Inspect door seals, racks, controls, and connections regularly for damage.
- Arrange authorised servicing if heating becomes uneven or unusual smells, sparks, or faults occur.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Loading food before the oven reaches the required preheating temperature.
- Overloading trays or blocking airflow in a convection oven.
- Touching hot racks or removing trays without heat-resistant gloves.
- Cleaning the oven while it remains hot or connected to power.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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